

BlenderShelf

Quick user guide



What it is

A floating panel of buttons over the 3D viewport, Maya-shelf style, plus a radial pie menu on a hotkey. Each button runs its own Python code on click.

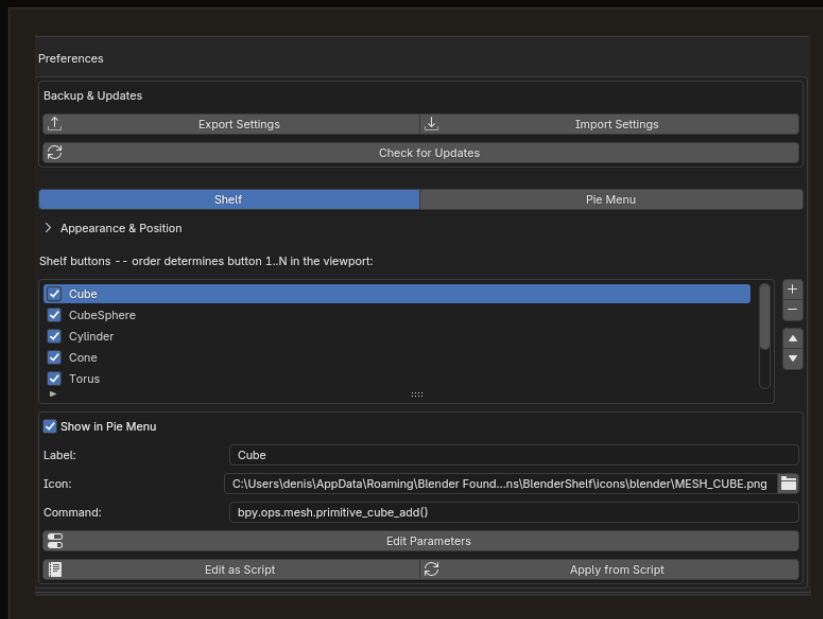
Orientation and moving the shelf



The ">" toggle and drag handle to the left of the panel

To the left of the panel: ">" toggles horizontal/vertical, and the three-dot handle drags with the mouse. Position is saved automatically.

Preferences: tabs and the button list



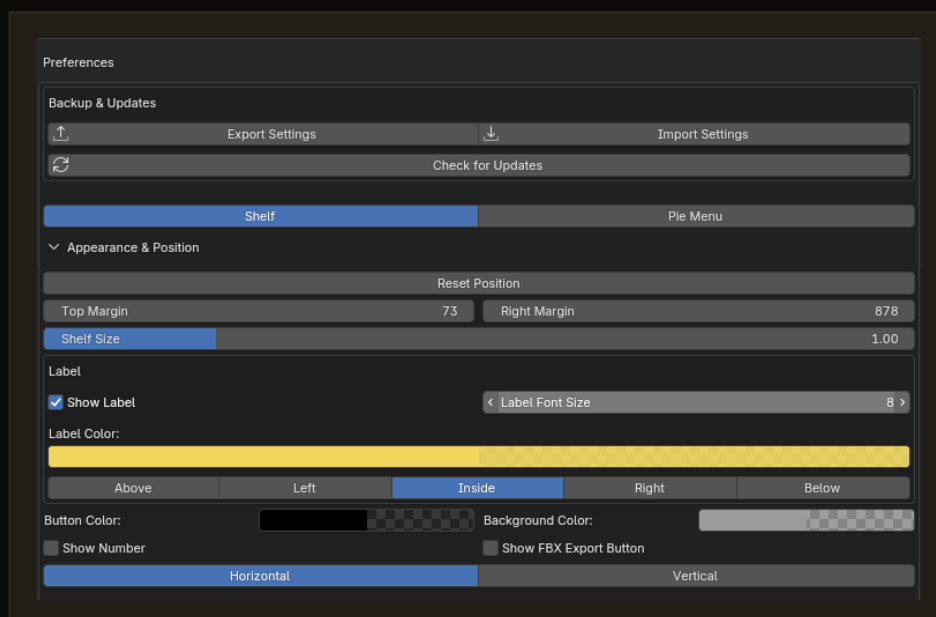
Backup & Updates, the Shelf/Pie Menu tabs, and the button list

The "Backup & Updates" box: Export/Import Settings save and load every addon setting as one JSON file, and "Check for Updates" checks the website for a newer release and, if one exists, offers a download link.

The Shelf tab holds the list of added functions.

Every function has its own card: label, icon, command.

Shelf appearance and position



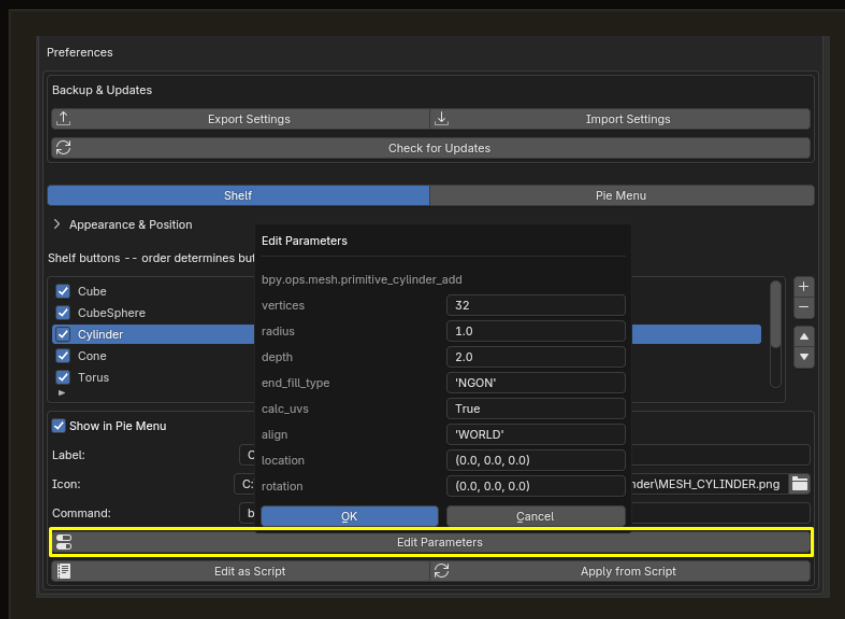
Appearance & Position: position, size, labels, colors

Inside the Shelf tab, a collapsible "Appearance & Position" panel holds a "Reset Position" button that returns the shelf to its default top-center spot, plus Top/Right Margin (position coordinates) and a button-size slider.

The Label block controls the captions (shown or not, font size, color, placement relative to the button); below it are button/background color, and Show Number — the display of ordinal numbers.

Show FBX Export Button turns on the FBX export button, with the Selected Only checkbox already enabled.

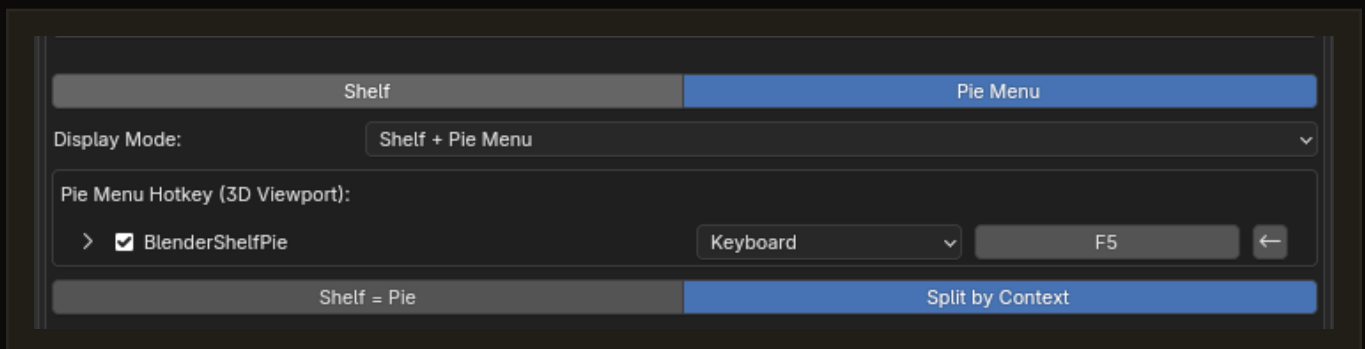
Adjusting parameters without Python



Edit Parameters: adjusting a cylinder's parameters without Python

"Edit Parameters" opens a window that lets you edit the parameters available for the function — a cylinder's vertex count, radius, and depth, for instance — with no need to write or edit a Python script by hand.

Pie menu: Shelf = Pie or Split by Context



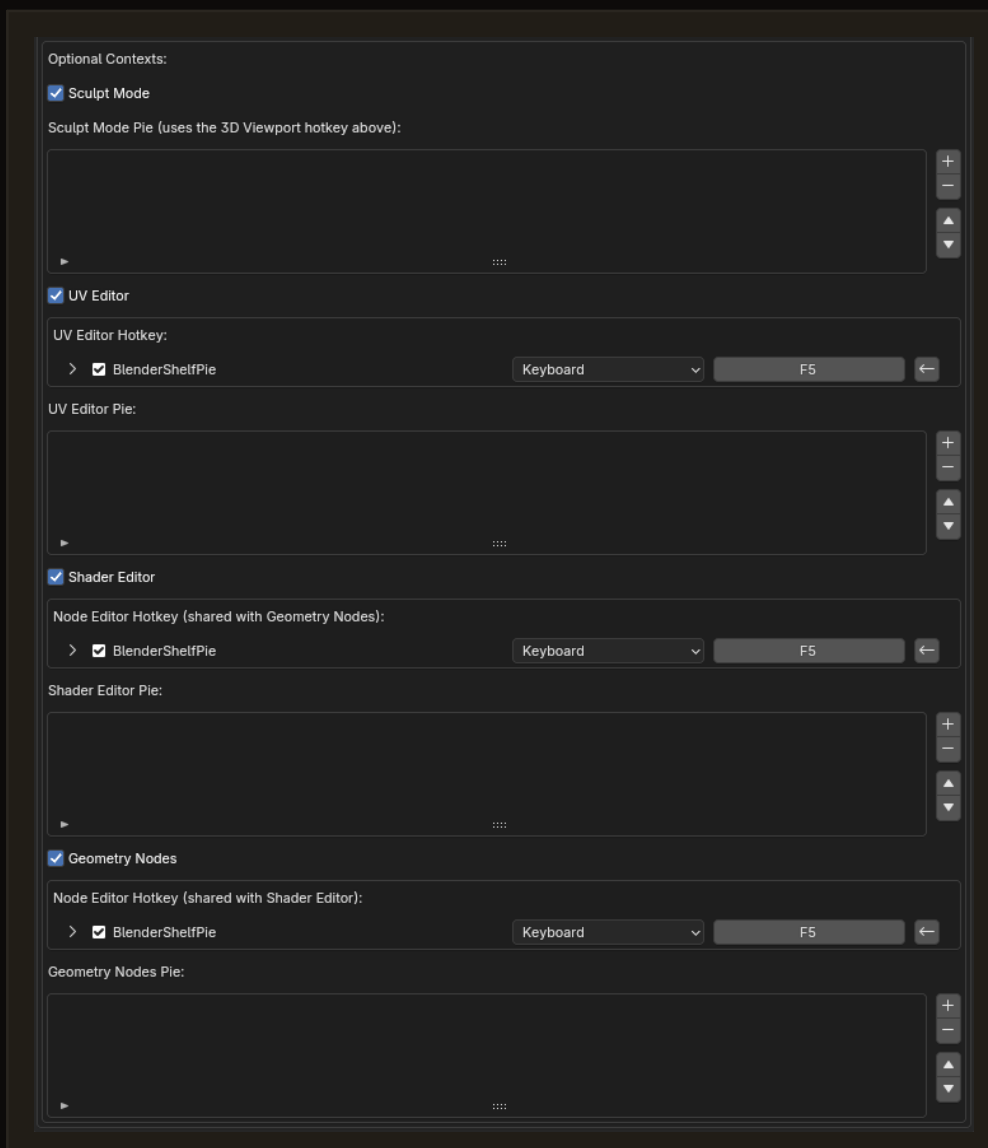
Display Mode, the hotkey, and the Shelf = Pie / Split by Context switch

The Pie Menu tab holds the display mode, the hotkey that opens the pie menu, and how the pie menu itself is built.

"Shelf = Pie" always mirrors the shelf's buttons. "Split by Context" builds independent pie menus: you can put functions into whichever list matches where they're meant to be called from — functions that only work in Edit Mode go into Pie: Edit Mode, and ones that work in Object Mode go into Pie: Object Mode.

That way, the same hotkey opens two different pie menus depending on which mode or editor window it was pressed in.

Optional contexts

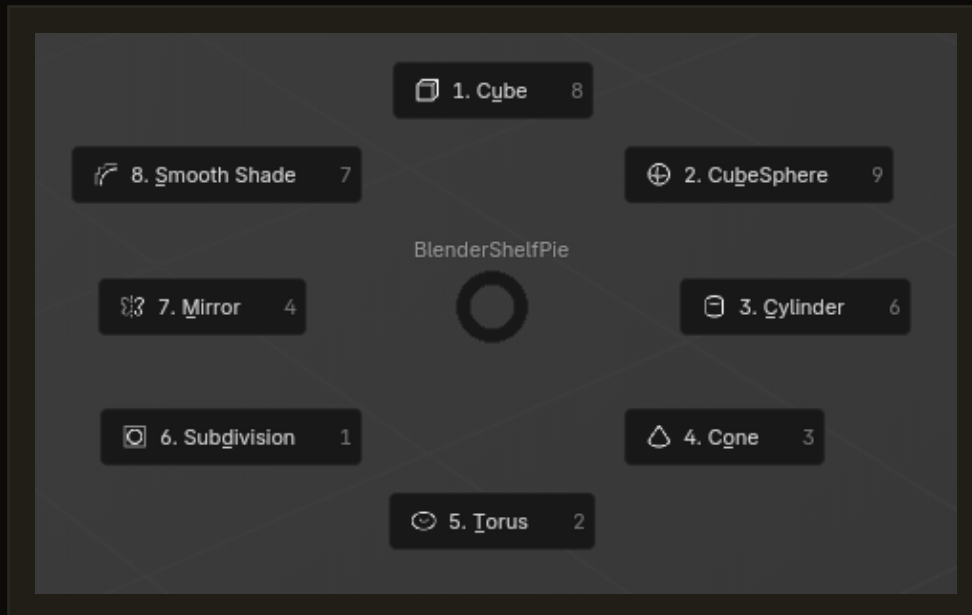


Optional Contexts: Sculpt Mode, UV Editor, Shader Editor, Geometry Nodes

In Split mode, an "Optional Contexts" block opens below with four more independent pie menus, each behind its own checkbox: Sculpt Mode, UV Editor, Shader Editor, Geometry Nodes. Enabled contexts float to the top of the list, disabled ones sink to the bottom.

Each context lets you set its own hotkey, but you can also use a single hotkey for all the contextual pie menus.

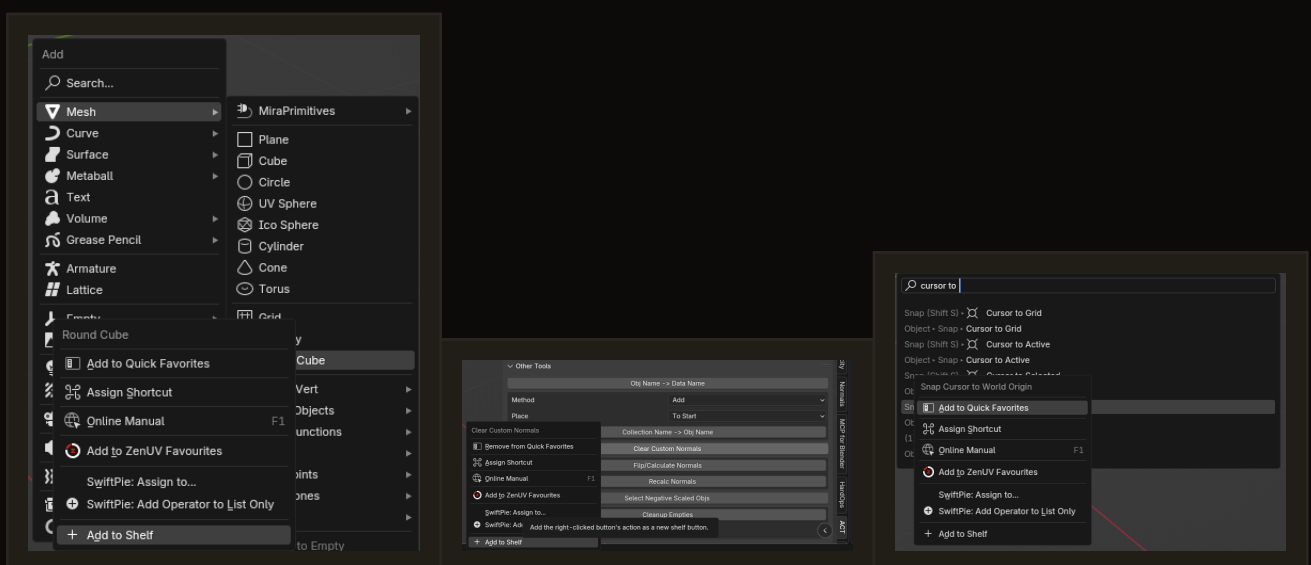
The pie menu in the viewport



BlenderShelf's pie menu in Split mode (Object Mode)

The assigned hotkey opens the radial menu. In Split mode, it shows only the current context's list, depending on which mode or editor window the pie menu was opened from. The order of functions always matches the order in the matching settings list.

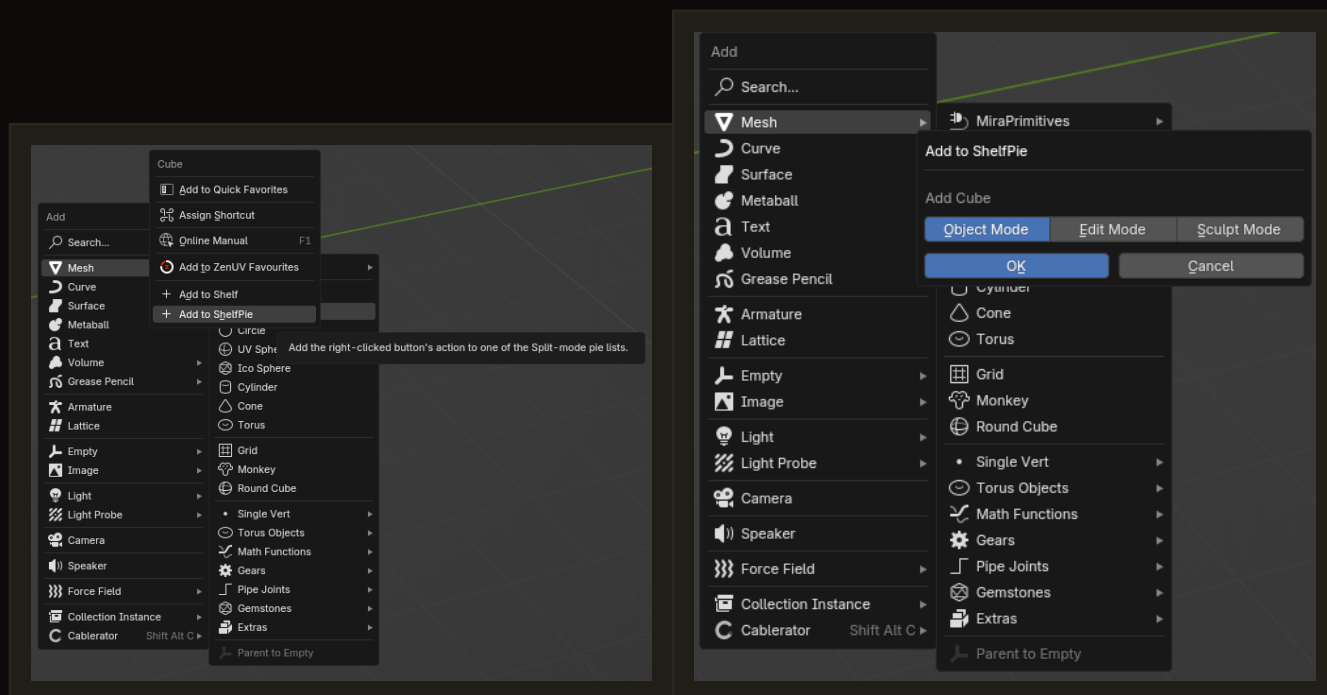
Adding a function (button) to the shelf



"Add to Shelf" works from any button's right-click menu: a built-in operator, a third-party addon's button, or a search (F3) result

1. "+" in the settings list — a blank slot; type in the command and label yourself.
2. Right-click any interface button, including third-party addons → "Add to Shelf".
3. Find the function via the operator search (F3), then the same way — right-click → "Add to Shelf".

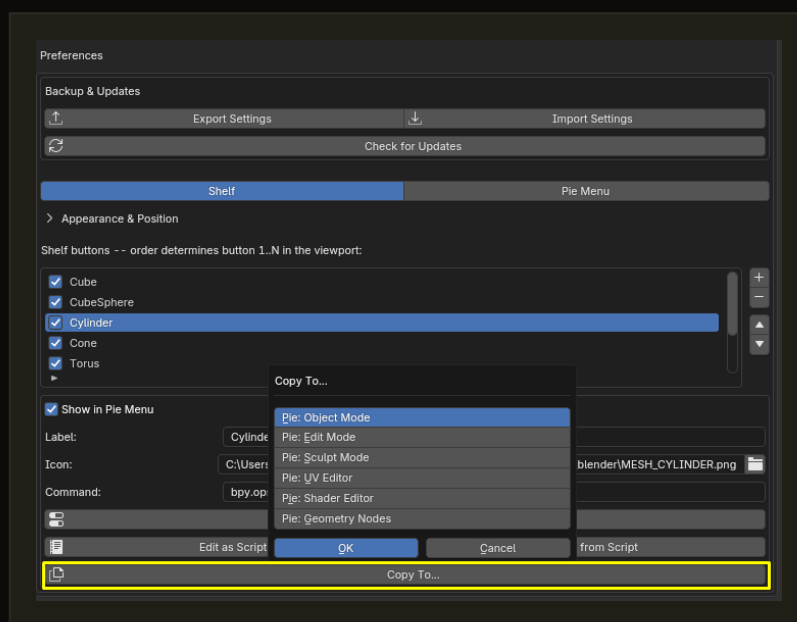
Adding a function (button) to the pie menu



"Add to ShelfPie" in the right-click menu, and the category-picker dialog

In Split mode, "Add to ShelfPie" appears next to "Add to Shelf" in the same right-click menu — the same right-click capture, but with a dialog to pick a category (Object Mode, Edit Mode, and any enabled Optional Contexts). The dialog pre-selects the category that fits the current context.

Copying functions between lists



"Copy To...": the list is filtered to the enabled pie lists

The "Copy To..." button below the function list copies it into another list — from the shelf into the Edit Mode pie, for instance. Editing the command in one list never touches the copy in the other.

Only available in Split mode — with Shelf = Pie there's nowhere to copy into, since the pie already mirrors the shelf.

What to put in Command

You can add your own script or macro (a sequence of commands), written yourself or by asking an AI (Claude, ChatGPT, and the like). For a quick tweak to a single operator call's parameters, "Edit Parameters" is easier — no need to edit Python by hand.